

Theresa (Tessa) DeConcini

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Education

Sep 2026 — Present: PhD Candidate and Doctoral Researcher [ONGOING]

Universität Leipzig, Leipzig, Saxony, Germany

Institute of Empirical Economic Research

Economics for Connected Natural Commons (ECO-N) Doctoral Research Training Group

Interdisciplinary Collaborative Project: Urban Air

2022 — 2025: MS, with Distinction, Sustainability [COMPLETE]

GPA: 4.0

Graduate Certificate in Environmental and Sustainability Economics

Arizona State University, Tempe, Arizona, USA

School of Sustainability, College of Global Futures

Thesis Paper: *Fair Share of Fresh Air? Decoding Implications of Environmental*

Justice Policy Directives in US Air Quality Monitoring Network Management

2020 — 2022: BA, Honors, Summa Cum Laude, Global Studies [COMPLETE]

Minor in Spanish Language Studies

GPA: 4.0

Arizona State University, Tempe, Arizona, USA

School of Politics and Global Studies, Barrett Honors, College of Liberal Arts and Sciences

Summa Cum Laude, Outstanding Graduate for the School of Politics and Global Studies

Universidad de Alicante, Alicante, Spain (Fall 2021)

Honors Thesis: *Challenges for Equitable Air Quality Monitoring in Urban, Low-Income*

Neighborhoods: A Comparison of Maricopa County, Arizona and the Metropolitan Region of Santiago, Chile

2024 — 2025: Anul Pregătitor Pentru Străini, Limba Română [COMPLETE]

Result: 10

In fulfillment of 2024 Boren Fellowship Award

Universitatea Româno-Americană, Bucharest, Romania

Faculty of International Business

Advanced-Intermediate (B2) Romanian Language Proficiency

2024 — 2026: Non-Degree Seeking Mathematics Courses

Pima County Community College, Tucson, Arizona, USA (online)

Ongoing, voluntary, non-degree seeking enrollment in a series of calculus courses to improve and maintain quantitative skills (Calc I, II, III, Differential Equations)

Research Interests: environmental & urban economics, air quality policy, equity, IAD/CIS frameworks.

Research Experience

Aug 2022 — May 2024: Graduate Assistant, ASU School for the Future of Innovation in Society

- Collaborated 20 hr/week research projects directed by Dr. Hernández-Cortés, with emphasis on economic disparities in environmental policy implementation, environmental justice, energy networks, federal and local regulation, and air quality.
- Conducted data analysis using quantitative and qualitative analysis, primarily in R.

Jan 2021 — May 2021: Junior Research Fellow, ASU School of Politics and Global Studies

- Assisted Dr. Glenn Sheriff on environmental economics research projects, primarily concerning air quality regulation in California and developed personal thesis research.
- Developed skills in data analysis, extracting key information from state and federal documents and legislation, and coordinating with public officials.

Aug 2021 — Dec 2021: Barrett Fellow, ASU Office of Gender Based Violence

- Collaborated with lead researchers and AmeriCorps Survivor Link volunteers to develop, implement, and measure impact of new social media strategy for community outreach.

Teaching Experience

2023: Barrett Summer Scholars Teacher & Instructional Designer for the College of Global Futures

- Designed and taught an accelerated sustainability science course for students aged 13-17.
- Developed curricula to introduce core sustainability concepts, foster collaboration, and strengthen students' critical thinking and reasoning skills.

Professional Experience (Non-Research Positions)

Jul 2024 — May 2025: Boren Fellow, Romania

- Awarded prestigious national fellowship to study Romanian language in Bucharest.
- Studied Romanian language in Preparatory Year program at Romanian-American University.

Jan 2022 — Aug 2023: Political Intern, Matters of State Strategies

- Facilitated client-facing projects for political campaigns, non-profit organizations, and political action committees, including strategy, translation, copywriting, and financial reporting.

Aug 2022 — Dec 2022: Political Coordinator, Adrian Fontes for Arizona Secretary of State

- Coordinated social media strategy and multi-media marketing campaigns, including short and long form copywriting with Communications team.

Jun 2021 — Aug 2021: Legislative Intern, United States Senate

- Assisted Senate staff with research, written analysis, and data analysis on relevant policy issues, constituent correspondence and casework.

May 2021 — Aug 2021: Project Intern, Arizona Democratic Party

- Created and maintained an effective constituent communication system to support Arizona Democratic Party projects and goals.

Jan 2018 — Jan 2021: Social Media Communications Associate, Vote Smart

- Created educational content, blog posts, social media communications, and advertising assets about nonpartisanship and informed voting.

Relevant Programming Skills

Quantitative data analysis in R and Microsoft Excel.

Qualitative data analysis in R and MaxQDA.

Technical Experience with LaTeX and LaTeX Editing Software (Overleaf).

Foreign Language Skills

English (Native) Spanish (C1) Romanian (B2) German (A1).

Publications and Working Papers

1. “Fair Share of Fresh Air? Decoding Implications of Environmental Justice Policy Directives in US Air Quality Monitoring Network Management” with Danae Hernández-Cortés (School for the Future of Innovation in Society and School of Sustainability, ASU), Kailin Kroetz (School of Sustainability, ASU), and Christopher Boone (Sol Price School of Public Policy, University of Southern California), *Work in Progress*, 2025. [Primary author, corresponding author]
2. “Is the Environmental Exposure Gap Shrinking? Evidence from an Extreme Multi-exposure Index” with Glenn Sheriff (School of Politics and Global Studies, ASU), Danae Hernández-Cortés (School for the Future of Innovation in Society and School of Sustainability, ASU), and Tirthankar “TC” Chakraborty (Pacific Northwest National Laboratory), NBER Working Paper 34739 (2026), <https://doi.org/10.3386/w34739>. [Co-author]
3. “Modeling procedural justice in public engagements with pipeline infrastructure: a coupled infrastructure systems approach to examining participatory environmental governance” with Kirk Jalbert (Department of Environment and Sustainability, University at Buffalo), Danae Hernández-Cortés (School for the Future of Innovation in Society and School of sustainability, ASU), Stacey Kuznetsov (School of Arts, Media, and Engineering, ASU), Natalie Florence, Morgan Leon Guerrero, and Alejandra Rodriguez, *Working Paper*, November 2025. [Co-author]

Presentations

2024: School of Sustainability, MS Capstone Project Defense

Fair Share of Fresh Air? Decoding Implications of Environmental Justice Policy Directives in US Air Quality Monitoring Network Management

Committee Chair: Dr. Danae Hernández-Cortés, ASU School of Sustainability

Committee Members: Dr. Kailin Kroetz, ASU School of Sustainability

Dr. Christopher Boone, ASU School of Sustainability

2024: Urban Climate Research Center Poster Competition

Awarded 2nd Place in the Graduate Student Competition, for “*Fair Share of Fresh Air?*”

2022: Barrett, the Honors College, Undergraduate Thesis Defense

Challenges for Equitable Air Quality Monitoring in Urban, Low-Income Neighborhoods: A Comparison of Maricopa County, Arizona and the Metropolitan Region of Santiago, Chile

Committee Chair: Dr. Glenn Sheriff, ASU School of Politics and Global Studies

Committee Members: Dr. Danae Hernández-Cortés, ASU School of Sustainability,
Dr. Darshan Karwat, ASU School for the Future of Innovation in Society

Conferences

2024: Interdisciplinary PhD Workshop in Sustainable Development (IPWSD), Workshop Participant, Columbia University, New York City.

2023: GF23 Global Futures Conference, “10 Must Haves” Workshop Participant, New York City.

Relevant Sustainability Science, Political Science, and Methodological Coursework

Graduate coursework:

2024: PAF 573 Applied Econometrics

SOS 581 Synthesis for Sustainability

2023: PUP 642 Urban and Regional Economic Analysis

PAP 504 Microeconomics of Public Policy I

SOS 520 Research Design and Methods for Sustainability

SOS 512 Environmental and Resource Economics

CPP 526 Foundations of Data Science I: Data Programming in R-Studio

2022: SOS 525 Social-Ecological-Technological Systems: Domains and Interfaces

SOS 598 Quantitative Tools for Sustainability Research

SOS 510 Perspectives on Sustainability

Undergraduate coursework:

SGS 401 Political Statistical Analysis

SGS 394 Global Markets

2021: SGS 303 Global Economic Trends

POS 356 Economic and Political Institutions of the EU

SGS 305 Empirical Political Inquiry

2020: SGS 330 Globalization and the Environment

Personal Interests

Long-distance walking/hiking, cycling, foreign language study, crochet, ceramics, political advocacy/volunteering, home-cooking.

Awards

2025: (MS) Boren Graduate Fellowship

2025: (MS) Graduation with Distinction

2022: (BA) Dean's Medalist/Outstanding Graduate, School of Politics & Global Studies

2022: (BA) Moeur Awardee

2022:(BA) Summa Cum Laude

Service

2024: SERVAS U.S. Marketing Team Volunteer

2023 – 2024: Supreme Court Justice, ASASU Student Government

2023 – 2024: Grad. Rep, School of Sustain.

Scholarships

2020 – 2024: (BA/MS) New American University Scholarship–President's Award

2020 – 2024: (BA/MS) Sun Devil State Award

2021: (BA) CDH Foundation, Local-to-Global Scholarship

2020: (BA) Phi Beta Kappa Scholarship

Memberships

2022 – Present: SERVAS International

2022 – 2024: Economics for Sustainability Lab, ASU School of Sustainability

2022: Phi Beta Kappa Society